9 Use the 6mm bowl gouge to make the initial cuts down the inside of the rim. Now the flute is in the 2 o'clock position with the bevel in contact with the underside of the rim. Press the gouge gently in and to the right. The gouge removes wood fairly quickly and easily with the bevel in contact on the underside of the rim – see diagram (a) – but soon there is a need to work further down the lower curve of the bowl. The gouge cannot easily be used to do this, and diagram (b) illustrates how the shape of the rim makes it impossible to cut across the bowl with the bevel supported. In this position there is little control over the tool other than a strong grip on it – this is a catch waiting to happen

9

10 Scrapers, on the other hand, are designed to be used with no support from the bevel, and so the small gouge can be replaced with a homemade 6mm scraper. This tool is used to gradually extend the cut sideways towards the bottom of the bowl until there is enough room to present a bowl gouge correctly

10

11

"Scrapers, on the other hand, are designed to be used with no support from the bevel, and so the small gouge can be replaced with a homemade 6mm scraper"

11 Reverting back to the 13mm bowl gouge, remove the waste from the centre of the bowl, although access near the rim is still very limited; I had to leave a 'bump' for removal later

12

12 With most of the waste taken out of the bowl centre, the bump was removed by light cuts from scrapers, finishing up with the final cuts from a large 38mm scraper held horizontally with the cutting edge exactly on centre height

13 Use callipers frequently to check the wall thickness and keep it fairly even, and take care to make sure that the transition from the rim curve to the bowl curve is as smooth and 'bump free' as possible

13

14 Hand sand the underside of the rim from 120 grit down to 400 grit before power sanding the more accessible interior of the bowl through the same grits. The interior and the rim can then be sealed and polished in the same way as the bottom of the bowl

14

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